

but when they tried their hands at them, they felt they were a little confusing to use. Cameras that could give users the quality of the DSLR while keeping the controls more or less like a conventional point and shoot would be great. Canon had one model – the PowerShot G10. The G11 was supposed to be on its way to the market, the shop keeper informed me. I remember looking at the specifications of this camera on the site. It has a better sensor for sure than every other point and shoot. It's also a costly camera with a market price of Rs. 29,000.

DSLRs have slowly gained popularity among enthusiasts. The thought of small sensors and limited controls is unbearable to some, which makes the DSLR ideal for such users. Dropping prices have helped the trend as well. Once you've thoroughly used a point and shoot,



Canon PowerShot SX 200 IS

there's little reason to not upgrade or buy a second camera – a DSLR.

Nikon's D40 and D40X are affordable DSLRs if you can find them anymore. Look for well maintained second hand pieces if you're willing to go in for one. You should find them for well under Rs. 18,000. This shop didn't have either of the two models but they had the D60 which is a good upgrade to the D40X. The shop only had a couple of pieces left. This model is getting phased out by the launch of the newer Nikon model – the D3000. It's the one to go for if you have a budget of somewhere around Rs. 35,000. If not, the D60 is next best choice. Canon's EOS 1000D was also there, but I didn't get the right feel holding the camera.

Olympus and Sony models were also present there. The Sony Alpha A200 is a very good alternative to the expensive DSLRs. The newer A220 hasn't been received very well from initial reactions by critics. Last I saw the A200, it was priced at Rs. 22,000 in the market – that's well under the price of the G10. It's not an excellent camera in terms of build quality and controls, still the price has to be impressive. If I had a really tight budget, this would be the one I would buy. Olympus' E-520 was the other camera which was priced Rs. 28,995 with the stock 14-42 mm lens.